



Week 1 Knowledge Check

Customer-Centric Foundations

Technical Product Manager Academy



How This Works

12 questions across the week — prompting, working backwards, personas, pain points, problem framing.

Commit to an answer **before** the reveal. Retrieval is the point.

? Question 1

The RCCF prompting scaffold stands for:

- A) Role, Constraints, Context, Feedback
- B) Role, Context, Constraints, Format
- C) Request, Context, Criteria, Format
- D) Role, Content, Clarity, Format



Answer 1 — B

Role, Context, Constraints, Format.

The kernel scaffold. Heavier frameworks (CO-STAR, CRISPE) are just elaborations of the same four-slot habit.

? Question 2

An AI gives a confident, plausible answer that's generic and not actually about *your* product. Most likely failure mode?

- A) Hallucination
- B) Sycophancy
- C) Context starvation
- D) Anchoring

Answer 2 — C

Context starvation. Plausible but generic.

Fix: add Role + Context explicitly, paste in the source material. (Hallucination = confident *fabricated specifics*; this one is generic.)

? Question 3

Rank the evidence tiers, most → least trustworthy:

- A) Reported → Observed → Inferred → AI-generated
- B) Observed → Reported → Inferred → AI-generated
- C) Observed → Inferred → Reported → AI-generated
- D) AI-generated → Observed → Reported → Inferred



Answer 3 — B

Observed → Reported → Inferred → AI-generated.

AI-generated is the lowest tier and must be upgraded before it's used in an artifact.

? Question 4 — True / False

A large-enough context window means the model will remember facts about your product from previous, separate sessions — even if you don't include them in this prompt.

Answer 4 — False

If the model can't see it in the prompt, it's **guessing**.

"What does this model know about my product right now? **Nothing.**"

? Question 5

In a Working Backwards PR/FAQ, which section is the *single most diagnostic* — if it sounds like marketing, the idea is in trouble?

- A) The heading
- B) The problem paragraph
- C) The customer quote
- D) The summary paragraph

Answer 5 — C

The customer quote.

If you can't write a fictional-but-credible quote believably, the PR fails. If it sounds like marketing, the problem *is* marketing.

? Question 6 — True / False

The core purpose of the Working Backwards document is to plan *how* to build a product the team has already decided to build.

Answer 6 — False

We don't use the document to plan what we'll build — we use it to decide **whether to build at all.**

"Fiction you can stress-test is cheaper than code you can't unship."

? Question 7

Which of the Five Questions That Force Clarity is where Day 1's evidence tiers re-enter?

- A) "Who is the customer?"
- B) "What is the most important benefit?"
- C) "How do you know what they want or need?"
- D) "What does the experience look like?"



Answer 7 — C

"How do you know what they want or need?"

Name the evidence. Tag its tier. This is the seam between customer research and the PR/FAQ.

? Question 8 — True / False

Writing a persona trait as an adjective — "busy," "tech-savvy" — is a strength because it captures the customer succinctly.

Answer 8 — False

Adjectives are the real killer — they're **un-falsifiable**.

Working personas use observed behaviors and the customer's own words, each tied to an evidence tier.

? Question 9

In a validation interview, which question should you **avoid**?

- A) "Walk me through the last time you did X."
- B) "Would you use a product that did X?"
- C) "What did you do to work around it?"
- D) "How often does that happen?"

Answer 9 — B

"Would you use a product that did X?"

The answer is always yes. Observe *past behavior* instead — it's the only reliable signal.

? Question 10

Where does the *most reliable* signal of real pain usually show up?

- A) Support tickets
- B) Observation / ride-alongs (workarounds, side-channels)
- C) Sales / loss reviews
- D) Analytics drop-offs

Answer 10 — B

Observation / ride-alongs.

The best pain points are the ones customers *stopped* complaining about — because they built a workaround. Silent pain = lucrative, easily missed.

? Question 11

In Severity $\times$ Frequency $\times$ Addressability, which axis do PMs forget — and when it's *low*, turns a pain into a communication problem, not a product one?

- A) Severity
- B) Frequency
- C) Addressability
- D) Reliability

Answer 11 — C

Addressability.

High severity + high frequency + *low* addressability = communicate, don't engineer. A red "Must fix" cell needs stakeholder framing, not a JIRA ticket.

? Question 12 — True / False

The line most problem statements skip — and the one that lets you know when you're actually done — is "Success looks like..."

Answer 12 — True

"**Success looks like...**" is the most-skipped line — and the one that makes a problem statement **falsifiable**.

Without it, there's no way to know when the problem is solved.



That's Week 1

Score yourself — but the real check is whether you can *use* these on Monday.